FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY REQUIREMENTS FOR CHAIRS, METAL AND PLASTIC, OFFICE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1. Scope. This specification covers the packaging, packing, and marking requirements (see 6.1) for Metal and Plastic Office Chairs.

1.2 Classification. This specification covers the packaging, packing, and marking requirements (see 6.2) for the chairs specified below:

Chairs, straight, as covered by AA-C-293 and AA-C-1772
Chairs, rotary, as covered by AA-C-293, AA-C-295, AA-C-1771 and AA-C-1772
Chairs, folding, as covered by AA-C-291

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

AA-C-275 - Chairs, Rotary and Straight, Aluminum, Office.
AA-C-291 - Chairs, Folding (Steel).
AA-C-293 - Chairs, Steel, General Office.
AA-C-295 - Chairs, Rotary, Steel, Tubular, Special Purpose.
AA-C-1771 - Chairs, Double Shell, Molded Plastic, Rotary, Upholstered, Middle Management.
AA-C-1772 - Chairs, Steel, General Office, Contemporary Style.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-640 - Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated, Triple-Wall.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard; Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, NW, Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General. The chairs shall be packaged using the materials and containers specified herein and in the applicable referenced specifications. The materials not covered by reference specifications shall be free from all defects and imperfections which may effect their serviceability.

3.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1 Level A.

3.2.1.1 Chair, straight. All finished surfaces of the chair which contact the inside of the shipping container shall be covered with cushioning material secured in place with tape or twine. The cushioning material shall extend not less than 2 inches above, below and to each side of the point of contact and shall be not less than 1/2 inch in thickness. The cushioning material shall be any of the following materials:

Macerated paper, wood-wool packing, wood fiber felt or creped cellulose wadding. Alternatively, the chair shall be placed in a cushioned bag which shall be closed and secured in place with tape or twine. The bag shall be constructed from material conforming to item 42352, Note 4, of the Uniform Freight Classification.

3.2.1.2 Chair, rotary. Prior to packaging, in order to achieve the minimum possible cube, the base shall be secured in the lowest position, if adjustable, and each chair shall be disassembled when the design permits. The chairs, when disassembled for packaging, shall be capable of being reassembled without the use of tools. When casters are removed they shall be packaged in a cloth or polyethylene bag that shall be secured to the rotary mechanism or chair leg to prevent loss or damage during shipment and storage. All finished surfaces of the chair which contact the inside of the shipping container or other disassembled parts of the chair shall be covered with cushioning material secured in place with tape or twine. The cushioning material and method of attachment of cushioning shall be as specified in 3.2.1.1.

3.2.1.3 Folding chairs. Each chair shall be folded and completely enclosed in a bag constructed from dry waxed kraft paper having a minimum basis weight of 48 pounds or a polyethylene film a minimum of 1.5 mils thick. The bags shall be secured with pressure sensitive tape or twine.

3.2.2 Level C. Each chair shall be packaged to insure protection during shipment and safe delivery at destination.

3.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

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3.3.1 Level A.

3.3.1.1 Non-folding chairs. Non-folding chairs packaged as specified in 3.2.1.1 or 3.2.1.2 shall be individually packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V13C minimum, style optional, or to PPP-B-640, class 2, style optional. The chair shall be suspended within the container on forms constructed from wood, or corrugated fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320, class domestic, grade 275 minimum, arranged to maintain not less than 1-1/2 inches of clearance between the lowest point of the chair and the bottom of the box. The suspension frame must bear against the structured frame of the chair base. When the weight of the chair exceeds 50 pounds, the corrugated forms must be constructed from fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320, class domestic, grade 350 minimum. Alternatively, the chairs shall rest on a platform which is the full inside dimensions at the container and is made of fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 minimum for chairs under 50 pounds and grade 350 for chairs that exceed 50 pounds. This platform shall be made of not less than two thicknesses of the material, with the flutes running at right angles to each other. The material shall be scored and folded to produce not less than four thicknesses at the points of contact with the legs or casters. Necessary blocking and bracing shall be utilized throughout the remainder of the container as required to prevent movement or damage during shipment and storage. The boxes shall be closed, waterproof sealed and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

3.3.1.2 Folding chairs. Four folding chairs packaged as specified in 3.2.1.3 shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, variety DW, style optional or to PPP-B-640, class 2, style optional. The chairs shall be cushioned within the box with any of the cushioning materials listed in 3.2.1.1. The cushioning shall provide a minimum of 3/4 inch of clearance between the individual chairs and between the chairs and the interior of the box. Close, waterproof, seal and strap the boxes in accordance with the appendix to the applicable box specification.

3.3.2 Level B. Chairs packaged as specified in 3.2.1.1, 3.2.1.2 and 3.2.1.3 shall be packed as specified in 3.3.1.1 or 3.3.1.2, as applicable except that the boxes shall conform to PPP-B-636, class domestic, variety DW, grade 275 (minimum) for chairs not exceeding 50 pounds and grade 350 minimum for chairs weighing 50 pounds and greater. The boxes shall be closed in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

3.3.3 Level C. Chairs packaged as specified in 3.2 shall be packed to comply with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules.

3.4 Marking. In addition to the marking, required by 3.4.3 and any marking required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 3.4.1 or 3.4.2 as specified (see 6.2).

3.4.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

3.4.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

3.4.3 Special marking. In addition to the markings required by 3.4.1 or 3.4.2, each shipping container shall be marked as follows in characters proportionate to the box size with a minimum of 3/4 inch height:

One side and one end of each container:

FURNITURE

FRAGILE - HANDLE WITH CARE

The lower right corner of the marked side of each container shall be marked with the applicable "F pack" number in the package certificate.

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The top panel of each shipping container:

TOP

THIS SIDE UP

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The upper corner of each side and end panel shall be marked with the word "UP" in characters a minimum of 2 inches high, and an arrow pointing to the top of the container.

Additionally, to facilitate color identification, the front and one end of each shipping container shall have an area approximately 3 inches by 8 inches painted to match the color of the item or items contained therein. Alternatively, color panels of the size specified above shall be applied to the container. The adhesive used shall be of such quality as to assure that the color panels will not loosen or become detached during shipment and storage.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. An inspection shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of section 3 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table I. For inspection of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged, or not conforming to the applicable specification or requirements stated herein.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling, or distortion of container.
Contents	Quantity per container is more or less than required. Gross weight exceeds the requirements of the box specification.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(Not applicable.)

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. It is intended that this specification be used for reference in section 5 of the commodity specifications listed in section 2 of this specification and for direct reference in procurement documents.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 3.2 and 3.3).
(c) Whether civil or military marking is required (see 3.4).
(d) Type of chair to be packaged and packed (see 1.2).

Preparing Activity:

GSA - FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 30 cents each. each.

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